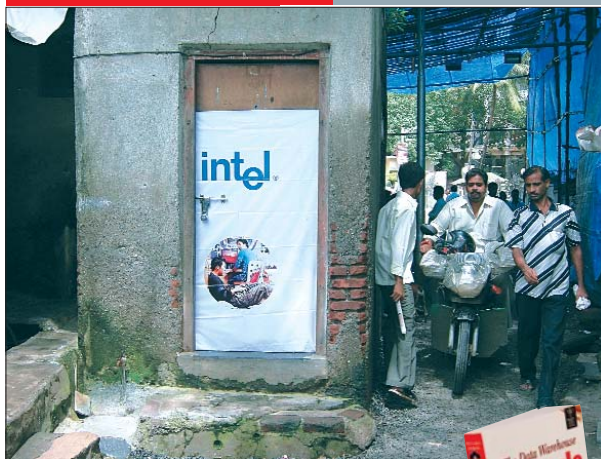


DigiPick of the month

"Intel Outside?"



Last month's winner is **Bhavik Panchal** Mumbai

Participate and win next month **Lifecycle Toolkit** by Ralph Kimball, Laura Reeves Margy Ross & Warren Thornthwaite

WILEY-INDIA

WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with the subject **'DigiPick'** and your postal address **on or before the 20th of this month** to digipick@thinkdigit.com. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

because now everyone can have just one IM client. Of course, promptly after this, it was rumoured that AOL would tie-up with Google!

Now, Google and Apple are supposedly in talks to merge Google Video content with Apple's iTV set-top box service. The rumours are based on the news that Google CEO Eric Schmidt joined the board of directors at Apple in August.

Of course, it's not just Google Video that might have Apple interested; there's also Gmail and search, Google's forte. Gmail can take care of the login/authentication aspect and bring millions of existing subscribers to iTV-land, and, let's face it, having Google's search expertise on your side just cannot be a bad thing!

Apple's iTV box and service is expected to launch in Q1 of 2007, so it will be a while before we know for sure. One thing we can predict is that no single

corporation seems to want to do it all alone, not even Microsoft! So expect to see many more reports of "tie-ups" happening in the news.

STOP BEING SO BORING

Cooler Apps For Vista Please!

Jim Allchin, President of the Platform Products and Services Group at Microsoft (read: big boss of Vista), has written an open letter to MSDN that asks developers to start building "cool" applications for Windows Vista.

Apart from the obvious changes in application programming, such as not requiring administrator privileges, using the new graphics API and DotNET 3.0, it seems that Microsoft are hoping that developers will harness the power of

Vista's graphics core and DirectX 10 to make "better-looking" applications as well.

It's a valid point, too; we've all seen the RC1 release of Vista, and have noticed that though the OS is cool, everything else looks exactly like Windows XP. A little transparency here and a sidebar there is all that hints at a brand new OS. Only techies understand why it's taken five years to build.

Perhaps this is why Microsoft might be interested in asking MSDN members to build "cooler" programs—to show the non-techies amongst us why it took so long to develop!

On another note, is it really "cool apps" we need? A poster on a message board has summed it up nicely for us: "No, Jim, Vista doesn't need 'cool' apps. It needs practically-conceived and well-executed applications that easily and quickly accomplish a task. After you've built that, then you can add the eye-candy."

OOPS!

Data Recovery Gems

UK data recovery specialists Disklabs, recently released a list of weird data disasters, in an article by *The Register* (www.theregister.co.uk). From the over 50,000 data recovery cases a year that Disklabs attends to, the weirdest requests were a cat urinating on a laptop; a salesman leaving his laptop

People Who Changed Computing

The Bit Defender

Prof Fred Cohen, on the 3rd of November 1983, created the first documented computer virus. He "injected" this virus into a graphical program called VD that was written for the Vax mini-computer. In his



Fred Cohen

demonstration, the virus paralysed the operation of the computer.

The term "virus" was only coined the next year. More than 110,000 viruses exist today. Cohen spent the next five years working on defences against viruses.

Cohen started theoretical research in the early 1980s; he set up practical experiments involving viral programs to demonstrate data theft and to show how a virus could seize the functioning of computer by virtue of its ability to replicate. In 1989, Cohen won the International Information Technology award for his work on data integrity protection.

Cohen has designed network protocols for secure transfer of voice, video, and data. He helped to develop a cash-watch, which we now know as the electronic wallet. His recommendations for good practices in data protection are now used the world over, including the idea that only trained system administrators should have complete access to critical components of a system like file servers, and that other users should have only limited access. The ideas of regular backups and audit trails to be maintained regularly are also due to Cohen.